

In a **PDF document called ethics.pdf**, provide your reflection on the following discussion points:

1. Peruse the [ACM Code of Ethics](#) that the author cites. Have you read a professional code of ethics before? Which three principles/responsibilities do you think are most important for fresh college grads entering the tech industry today? Why?

I have not read a professional code of ethics before. In my mind, I think the first one “Contribute to society and to human well-being, acknowledging that all people are stakeholders in computing.”, “Respect privacy.”, and “Maintain high standards of professional competence, conduct, and ethical practice.” are the most important. I think the first one seems to be the most important to me, because the idea of upholding human dignity and well-being is a fundamental part of not just a functioning and ethical company, but society at large. It’s also important to build a foundation for ethical practices. When the goal is human dignity and well-being, inherently ethical practices are part of the mission, and there’s purpose and meaning behind the other rules and guidelines. I think in our current age of tech and data “Respect Privacy” is a huge responsibility, mostly for my aforementioned reasons and because of a lack of respect for privacy that we’ve seen in recent years. Maintaining high personal standards are also important because they keep you accountable to excellence, ethics, and innovation in the industry.

2. What do you think of the parallel the author draws between Big Tobacco and Big Tech? In this context, is it a fair comparison? Why or why not?

I thought it was interesting. I honestly do think it was a valid comparison. Tobacco has a history of intentional deception that has caused many people hurt and pain. Big Tech has the opportunity to also cause pain if they engage in unethical practices. However, in my own opinion, tobacco really has no good use, whereas Big Tech has the potential to create good.

3. What are your career aspirations? Are you considering working at a Big Tech company? What are "hard questions" you think current and aspiring Big Tech workers should be asking themselves?

I’m a physics major, and I’m interested in research. So I don’t see myself pursuing a career in Big Tech, but ethical data science practices are still applicable for me. I think one “hard question” is where the line is between ethical and non-ethical practices actually lie. I think it’s easy to agree that non-ethical practices are bad, but defining what exactly is a non-ethical practice is more difficult. When you define what is ethical and what’s not, you have to take into account the outcomes of your actions and how the positives and negatives weigh out.

